V E L A

P R I V A T E C O M M A N D I N F R A S T R U C T U R E

Read Me First

Pre-Installation Credential & Account Setup Guide.
Complete every step before your installation call.

Your judgment. Our infrastructure.

Version 2.0 · March 2026

🚨 STOP. Read This Before You Touch Anything.

This guide lists every account, credential, and API key required to install VELA. The install script will ask for all of them. If you don't have them ready, the install will fail.

Estimated time: 45–90 minutes. Store all values in a password manager — never in email or Notes.

01 What You're Installing

VELA is private command infrastructure running on a Mac Mini M4 in your home or office. It connects to your email, calendar, Telegram, WhatsApp, and Google Drive — and acts as a Chief of Staff plus five specialist agents, all on hardware you own. You sign in once during installation. After that, everything runs autonomously.

Service	What VELA Uses It For	Time
VELA License Key	Activates your system — provided by your installer	0 min
Anthropic API	Powers Hannah and your specialist agents	5 min
Telegram	Your primary command channel	5 min
Google OAuth — Gmail	Email triage, drafts, send on your behalf	10 min
Google OAuth — Drive	Auto-upload of all agent deliverables	10 min
Google Cloud API	Enables Google service connections	15 min
WhatsApp	Secondary command interface	2 min (QR scan)
Tailscale	Secure remote access for your installer	5 min
Google Drive Backup Folder	Nightly automated system backups	5 min

02 Credentials to Collect

Work through these in order. Each card tells you exactly what you need and where to get it.

🔒 Security Protocol: treat every value here as a password. Store in 1Password, Bitwarden, or Apple Keychain. Do not screenshot this document with values filled in.

CREDENTIAL 1 OF 9	REQUIRED **VELA License Key** 🔒
WHAT YOU NEED	License Key — format: VELA-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX
WHERE TO GET IT	Provided by your installer — greg@gregshindler.com

NOTES	Your installer gives you this key before the installation call. It activates your system and is unique to you.
YOUR VALUE — PASTE HERE	

CREDENTIAL 2 OF 9	**REQUIRED Anthropic API Key** 🔒
WHAT YOU NEED	API Key starting with sk-ant-
WHERE TO GET IT	console.anthropic.com → Settings → API Keys → + Create Key
NOTES	Create account at anthropic.com. Name the key VELA. Copy immediately — shown only once. Add billing before use. Recommended limit: $100/month.
YOUR VALUE — PASTE HERE	

🔒 Billing required: your Anthropic key won't work without a credit card. console.anthropic.com → Settings → Billing. Set a monthly limit of $100–200.

CREDENTIAL 3 OF 9	**REQUIRED Telegram Bot Token** 🔒
WHAT YOU NEED	Bot Token — long alphanumeric string
WHERE TO GET IT	Telegram → search @BotFather → send /newbot
NOTES	Search @BotFather (blue checkmark). Send /newbot, follow prompts. Username must end in bot. Copy token immediately.
YOUR VALUE — PASTE HERE	

CREDENTIAL 4 OF 9	**REQUIRED Telegram User ID + Group ID** 🔒
WHAT YOU NEED	Two numeric IDs: personal ID (positive) and group ID (negative)
WHERE TO GET IT	Telegram → search @userinfobot
NOTES	Part A: message @userinfobot — replies with your user ID. Part B: create a group, add your bot as admin, message @userinfobot inside the group for the group ID (negative number, e.g. -1003750313044).
YOUR VALUE — PASTE HERE	

CREDENTIAL 5 OF 9	REQUIRED **Google OAuth — Gmail & Calendar** 🔒
WHAT YOU NEED	OAuth Client ID and Client Secret from Google Cloud Console
WHERE TO GET IT	console.cloud.google.com → APIs & Services → Credentials → Create OAuth Client ID
NOTES	Create project VELA. Enable Gmail API and Google Calendar API. OAuth consent: External, add Gmail as test user. Credentials: Desktop app type. Download JSON — you need client_id and client_secret.
YOUR VALUE — PASTE HERE	

CREDENTIAL 6 OF 9	REQUIRED **Google OAuth — Drive Access**
WHAT YOU NEED	Drive API enabled — refresh token auto-generated during install
WHERE TO GET IT	Same Google Cloud project as Credential 5 — enable Drive API separately
NOTES	In same project: APIs & Services → Library → Google Drive API → Enable. The install script handles authorization automatically.

No action needed for Credential 6 — generated automatically during install.

CREDENTIAL 7 OF 9	OPTIONAL **WhatsApp Account**
WHAT YOU NEED	Phone with WhatsApp installed — no key required, scan a QR code
WHERE TO GET IT	Your existing WhatsApp account — no new account needed
NOTES	During install: WhatsApp → Settings → Linked Devices → Link a Device → scan QR on screen.

No value to collect for Credential 7 — scan a QR code during installation.

CREDENTIAL 8 OF 9	REQUIRED **Tailscale Account**
WHAT YOU NEED	Free account — your installer provides an auth key
WHERE TO GET IT	tailscale.com → Sign Up (free personal plan — up to 3 devices)
NOTES	Tailscale gives your installer secure remote access for support. Your installer handles all configuration.

No value to collect for Credential 8 — your installer handles Tailscale setup.

CREDENTIAL 9 OF 9	RECOMMENDED **Google Drive Backup Folder**
WHAT YOU NEED	Folder ID from the URL — long alphanumeric string

WHERE TO GET IT	drive.google.com → New Folder → VELA Backups → copy ID from URL
NOTES	Create folder named VELA Backups. Open it and copy the ID from the URL — everything after /folders/.
YOUR VALUE — PASTE HERE	

03 Accounts & Subscriptions Summary

Service	Account Type	Notes
Anthropic	Pay-as-you-go	Credit card required — typical $90–450/month
Telegram	Free	App on phone required
Google (Gmail)	Free / Workspace	Same account used for Google Cloud
Google Cloud	Free tier	No charges within standard API quotas
Tailscale	Free personal	Up to 3 devices — installer manages setup

04 What the Installer Will Ask For

Have this list open when you run the install command in Terminal.

Prompt	What to Enter	Source
VELA License Key	VELA-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX	Your installer
Your full name	e.g. {{CLIENT_NAME}}	Your name
Your company	e.g. {{CLIENT_COMPANY}}	Your company
Your role / title	e.g. {{CLIENT_ROLE}}	Your title
Agent name	Hannah (or your preference)	Your choice
Primary Gmail	your@gmail.com	Your Gmail
CoS Gmail	cos@gmail.com	Your CoS email
Mac Mini username	no spaces, e.g. johnsmith	Your Mac login
Anthropic API key	sk-ant-...	Credential 2
Telegram Bot Token	1234567890:ABC...	Credential 3
Telegram Group ID	-1003750313044 (negative)	Credential 4
Telegram User ID	987654321 (positive)	Credential 4
Drive Backup Folder ID	1ABC123xyz...	Credential 9

05 Pre-Installation Checklist

Every unchecked item is a potential reason the install could fail.

Hardware

- ☐ Mac Mini M4 — 16 GB minimum, 32 GB recommended
- ☐ Ethernet cable connected (not WiFi)
- ☐ Power connected — do not run on battery during install
- ☐ System Settings → Energy → Prevent automatic sleep: ON
- ☐ System Settings → Software Update → set to manual

Credentials

- ☐ VELA License Key received from your installer
- ☐ Anthropic API key created and billing configured
- ☐ Telegram bot token in hand
- ☐ Telegram User ID and Group ID collected
- ☐ Google Cloud project created — OAuth Client ID and Secret downloaded
- ☐ Gmail API, Google Calendar API, and Google Drive API all enabled
- ☐ Google Drive VELA Backups folder created — Folder ID copied
- ☐ All values stored in password manager

06 Quick Reference — All Links

Service	URL
Anthropic API Keys	console.anthropic.com/settings/keys
Anthropic Billing	console.anthropic.com/settings/billing
Telegram BotFather	t.me/BotFather
Telegram ID Bot	t.me/userinfobot
Google Cloud Console	console.cloud.google.com
Google APIs Library	console.cloud.google.com/apis/library
Google OAuth Credentials	console.cloud.google.com/apis/credentials
Tailscale	tailscale.com/start
Google Drive	drive.google.com